with the rest of the community. Had the modernisers won the battle for Muslim hearts and minds the situation might well be different, but it was the traditionalists who emerged triumphant, in part because of fears over the prospect of Hindu majority rule with the approach of Independence but also because of the continuing rise of peaceful but separatist Deobandism.

In India today two thirds of its Sunni Muslim population are Barelvis who are essentially hostile to the Deobandis' ultraconservative model. Both communities reject violence and are in many respects model and loyal citizens. Yet the temptation to follow the Deobandi model of separatism remains, and for any minority to seek to live separate lives divorced from the mainstream is essentially destabilising for both parties, the majority community quite as much as the minority.

It is a sad fact that while Kerala regularly comes top of the state league tables in such areas as literacy, healthcare and the elimination of poverty, it is the Muslim community, making up just over a quarter of Kerala's population, who lag behind when it comes to such areas of social development as birth rates, infant mortality and numbers working abroad in the Gulf. Continuing links with Saudi Arabia and the Yemen have brought about a degree of 'Arabisation', which manifests itself in increased conservatism in dress and attitudes, and growing intolerance towards anything that could be considered as insulting to the Prophet, as in the case of the assault that took place in the Ernakulam District in 2010 on a Christian professor of Malayalam. His crime was to have set an exam question based on a university-approved text that offended a Muslim extremist group calling itself the Popular Front of India. Equally shocking was the outcome: the dismissal of the professor from his post at the Mahatma Gandhi University for 'offending the religious sentiments of a